Baby cereals & dry grain products: HMTc Standard

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CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

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Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for dry infant cereals and grain products, stated as-sold. Rice-based products carry a distinct inorganic-arsenic limit. Every limit is the strictest maximum level any credible government sets, converted to the as-sold basis, with read-across where no government regulates the exact product.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default, 8:1 basis, read-across)

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

Variants on this standard: rice-based and non-rice. Where a cell differs between them the limit column shows both (value per variant); the derivation below is stated for rice-based.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	40	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	50	government maximum level

Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	20	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	8	human-grade read-across (Israel)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	—	not compiled
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	3,000	government maximum level
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	5,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	500	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,000	government maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	—	not compiled

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	20	government maximum level
Cadmium (Cd)	40	government maximum level
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	government maximum level
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	20	European Union — human-food analog
Mercury, total (tHg)	8	Israel — human-food analog
Methylmercury (MeHg)	—	not compiled
Nickel (Ni)	3,000	government maximum level
Tin (Sn)	5,000	government maximum level
Aluminium (Al)	500	Australia / New Zealand — human-food analog
Total chromium (Cr)	1,000	government maximum level
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	—	not compiled

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. (2026). *Baby cereals & dry grain products: HMTc standard* (Version 1.0). Institute of Contaminant Standards.

References

[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds iAs. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] Israel — human-food maximum levels
Binds tHg. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

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COMPETING INTERESTS

This briefing is published by the Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) program, operated by the Institute of Contaminant Standards. Its statements about government regulations, toxicology, and occurrence are sourced to the cited primary and expert-body records and to the independently maintained Heavy Metal Index; the program's own certification thresholds are not used as evidence for any factual claim made here.

DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/baby-cereals--dry. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/baby-cereals--dry.